



International Conference on Campaign Finance and Expenditure in Elections

18th June 2026

Organised by

Office of Chief Electoral Officer, Chhattisgarh

In Association With

**INDIA INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DEMOCRACY AND ELECTION
MANAGEMENT (IIIDEM)**

&



**Hidayatullah National Law University
Raipur, Chhattisgarh**

Conference Background

Modernizing Electoral Ecosystems

Campaign finance remains one of the most under-regulated dimensions of India's electoral ecosystem. Unregulated money flows distort democratic outcomes, entrench political inequality, and erode public trust in electoral institutions. India's existing framework, while evolving, continues to face critical challenges around disclosure norms, enforcement gaps, and the influence of undisclosed funding. Modernizing the electoral ecosystem demands a comprehensive reimagining of campaign finance laws, digital disclosure mechanisms, and the institutional role of election management bodies. This conference positions itself at the centre of that urgent reform conversation.

Benchmarking Global Innovations

Election bodies worldwide have introduced innovative campaign finance reforms. Countries like Canada and Brazil use real-time expense disclosure systems. Germany and Sweden follow strong public funding models. AI-based monitoring and open-data dashboards have improved transparency globally. While Election Commission of India has made important progress, enforcement gaps remain. This conference explores global best practices adaptable to the Indian democratic system.

Strategic Conference Goals

This conference aims to generate evidence-based, actionable insights on campaign finance regulation to inform policy, legal reform, and institutional practice. It seeks to build a structured multi-stakeholder dialogue among legal scholars, electoral administrators, and the academic community. A core goal is to expose students and research scholars to comparative international perspectives otherwise inaccessible in conventional academic settings. The conference further aspires to produce documented deliberations serving as a reference for future reform advocacy, contributing to the constitutional vision of free and fair elections.

Synergistic Global Engagement

The conference is built on the principle that electoral reform is most effective when globally informed and locally grounded. By engaging international election management bodies through IIIDEM, it creates a platform for cross-jurisdictional knowledge exchange on campaign finance governance. Each session deliberately pairs a global perspective with a Chhattisgarh-based expert, ensuring international insights are contextualised within India's constitutional framework. The hybrid format further democratises access, enabling participation from scholars and faculty across Chhattisgarh — making this conference collaborative, comparative, and consequential.

Conference Objectives

The overarching objective is to establish a comprehensive platform to review, analyze, and enhance mechanisms for campaign finance regulation and expenditure oversight in democratic systems

01

Promote international dialogue on campaign finance standards, contribution limits, and disclosure requirements.

02

Build consensus on best practices for expenditure regulation and cost containment in political campaigns.

03

Explore mechanisms for ensuring transparency and preventing money laundering in political funding.

04

Develop evidence-based policy recommendations on public and state funding for equitable political participation.

05

Address emerging challenges: digital funding, dark money networks and AI in campaign finance.

Who can Participate

01

Academics & Researchers

Universities, colleges, and research institutions guiding on their expertise in Campaign Finance and its different aspects.

02

Stakeholders- State participation

CEO of states along with officers involved in the campaign finance regulations.

03

Election Management Bodies

Officers and officials from Election Management Bodies across the globe

04

IT & Technology Professionals

Specializing in electoral system architecture, secure data management, and integrated digital platforms- working to regulate Campaign Finance and Expenditure

05

Stakeholders- District Participation

DEOs of Chhattisgarh along with officers involved in the campaign finance regulations.

06

Students & Early-Career Researchers

Researching on Campaign Finance and related fields including its legal angle

Thematic Tracks/Session

01

**Contribution Regulation:
Foundations of Clean Money
Framework**

04

**Disclosure, Transparency &
Oversight: Making Campaign
Finance Legible**

02

**Expenditure Regulation:
Controlling the Cost of
Democracy**

05

**Emerging & Cross-Cutting Issues:
Digital Frontiers, Organized Crime
& AI in Campaign Finance**

03

**Public & State Funding:
Equitable Architectures
for Political Financing**

06

Concluding Session

Programme Schedule

Time IST (UST/GMT +5:30)	Programme	Duration
09:30 to 10:00 Hours	Arrival at the Venue of Guests and Physical Participants and Welcome Tea	30 min
10:00 to 10:03 Hours	Felicitation of Guests	03 min
10:03 to 10:06 Hours	Welcome Remarks by Vice Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) V.C. Vivekanandan, HNLU, Raipur, Chhattisgarh	03 min
10:06 to 10:09 Hours	Opening Remarks by Shri Bhoskar Vilas Sandeepan (IAS), Additional Chief Electoral Officer, Raipur, Chhattisgarh	03 min
10:09 to 10:13 Hours	Opening Remarks by Shri Yashwant Kumar (IAS), Chief Electoral Officer, Raipur, Chhattisgarh	04 min
10:13 to 10:18 Hours	IIIDEM	05 min
10:18 to 10:20 Hours	Momento to Guests	02 min
10:20 to 10:25 Hours	Vote of thanks and Conference Brief by Registrar Dr. Deepak Kumar Shrivastava, , HNLU, Raipur, Chhattisgarh	05 min
10:25 to 10:45 Hours	Tea Break	20 min
10:45 to 11:30 Hours	SESSION 1- Contribution Regulation: Foundation of a Clean Money Framework 10 mins- Opening Remark by Speaker 01, 10 mins- presentation by EMB- I and 25 mins for panel discussion and QNA	45 min
11:30 to 11:35 Hours	Session Break	05 min

Programme Schedule

11:35 to 12:20 Hours	SESSION 2- Expenditure Regulation: Controlling the Cost of Democracy 10 mins- Opening Remark by Speaker 01, 10 mins- presentation by EMB- II and 25 mins for panel discussion and QNA	45 min
12:20 to 12:25 Hours	Session Break	05 min
12:25 to 13:10 Hours	SESSION 3- Public & State Funding: Equitable Architectures for Political Financing 10 mins- Opening Remark by Speaker 01, 10 mins- presentation by EMB- III and 25 mins for panel discussion and QNA	45 min
13:10 to 14:30 Hours	Lunch	80 min
14:30 to 15:15 Hours	SESSION 4- Disclosure, Transparency & Oversight: Making Campaign Finance Legible 10 mins- Opening Remark by Speaker 01, 10 mins- presentation by EMB- IV and 25 mins for panel discussion and QNA	45 min
15:15 to 15:35 Hours	Tea Break	20 min
15:35 to 16:30 Hours	SESSION 5- Emerging & Cross-Cutting Issues: Digital Frontiers, Organized Crime & AI in Campaign Finance 10 mins- Opening Remark by Speaker 01, 10 mins- presentation by EMB- V and 35 mins for panel discussion and QNA	55 min
16:30 to 17:00 Hours	Concluding Remarks	30 min

Expected Outcomes



01

Comprehensive review of campaign finance regulations across diverse democratic systems and jurisdictions.



03

Evidence-based recommendations for effective spending limits and cost containment strategies.



05

Development of actionable policy recommendations for equitable and transparent political financing.



02

Identification of best practices for disclosure requirements and oversight of political funding sources



04

Analysis of emerging challenges, including online funding, dark money networks, and algorithmic influence.



06

Synthesis of international experiences and best practices for enhanced campaign finance governance.

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